immediately following VOC's arrest, water barrels on the way to the port were intercepted by sepoys and policemen who forced the carriers to empty the water 'for the use of themselves, their friends, and masters, or others as they direct'.[15] Even if this may not have happened on the express orders of local officers, clearly their minions, hostile to the Swadeshi company because of their prestige having taken a beating during the protest 'riots', abused the situation prevailing after the pacification.

In fact, every arm of the colonial state was used to intimidate the company. The executive and judiciary apart, the port authorities too were involved in these tactics. (We may recall that, on 13 March, Port Officer Lieutenant W.L. Kelly and the Assistant Commissioner of Salt Cecil Ewald Rhenius had joined the police party led by Ashe that charged the protest meeting.) In late March 1908, the port officer held up the *Gallia* on the charge of not possessing the full complement of qualified officers.[16] The Swadeshi company was prevented from clearing the ship: passengers and cargo in the vessel were stopped even though the Colombo authorities had cleared them.[17] Reported in the press,[18] the issue was even raised in the Madras Legislative Council. Based on the officiating presidency port officer's report, the government stated that when the *Gallia* had arrived at Tuticorin, its master (captain) had applied for clearance. While he possessed an English certificate, the mate held a Norwegian certificate which was not valid under the Indian Merchant Seamen's Act, 1859. Therefore, the latter had to go to Colombo and obtain a new certificate from the Ceylon government. But that too was declared invalid.[19] It is curious why this issue cropped up suddenly; the vessel had employed the same crew for many months. The attempt at intimidation was so brazen that SSNCo issued a notice to the port office threatening to sue for damages.[20] How this issue was finally resolved is not known. 'These high-handed proceedings are regretted by the public … It is clear that the Swadeshi Co. is aimed at.'[21]